



AGENCY FOR HEALTHCARE RESEARCH AND QUALITY



MEPS-HC

Health Care Utilization and Expenditures

Jerrod Anderson, Ph.D.

MEPS Components

Medical Expenditure Panel Survey (MEPS)

Household
Component
(HC)

Medical Provider
Component
(MPC)

Insurance
Component
(IC)

MEPS Components

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MEPS Components

Medical Expenditure Panel Survey (MEPS)

Household Component (HC)

- Demographics
- Income
- Health Conditions
- Health Status
- Health Insurance
- **Utilization**
- **Expenditure Data**

Medical Provider Component (MPC)

- Event Details
- Procedure Codes
- **Expenditure Data**

Insurance Component (IC)

Healthcare Utilization

- MEPS household respondents asked to report all healthcare use for family members during reference period
- Utilization is called an “event” in MEPS
- Event type categories:
 - ▶ Hospital inpatient stays (IP)
 - ▶ Office-based medical provider visits (OB)
 - ▶ Outpatient department visits (OP)
 - ▶ Emergency room visits (ER)
 - ▶ Dental visits (DN)

 - ▶ Prescription medicine purchases (RX)
 - ▶ Home healthcare (HH)
 - ▶ Other medical expenses (OM)
(e.g., glasses, hearing aids)

Healthcare Utilization

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 - ▶ Prescription medicine purchases (RX)
 - ▶ Home healthcare (HH)
 - ▶ Other medical expenses (OM)
(e.g., glasses, hearing aids)
- “Event” definition:
- stay
- visit
- original script or refill
month of care
purchase

Event Files

https://meps.ahrq.gov/mepsweb/data_stats/download_data_files.jsp

:: What's New
:: Mailing List
:: Discussion Forum
:: Participants' Corner

- ☐ **Household Component Full-Year files** ⓘ
Expenditure and utilization data for the calendar year from several rounds of data collection.
 - ☐ Full-Year Consolidated Data files
 - ☐ Full-Year Population Characteristics files
 - ☐ Medical Conditions files
 - ☐ Risk Adjustment Scores files
 - ☐ Employment Variables file
 - ☐ Jobs files
 - ☐ Person Round Plan files
 - ☐ Longitudinal Data files
 - ☐ Supplemental Variables files (1996-2000)
 - ☐ Health Insurance Plan Abstraction file (1996)
 - ☐ Long Term Care file (1998)
- ☐ **Household Component Event files** ⓘ
Data for the calendar year on unique household reported medical events.
 - ☐ Prescribed Medicines files
 - ☐ Dental Visits files
 - ☐ Other Medical Expenses files
 - ☐ Hospital Inpatient Stays files
 - ☐ Emergency Room Visits files
 - ☐ Outpatient Visits files
 - ☐ Office-Based Medical Provider Visits files
 - ☐ Home Health files
 - ☐ Appendix to MEPS Event files

Event Files

Event Files

OB Event File, 2023

Person / Event IDs		Date		Payment/Charge		Person Weight
dupersid	evntidx	obdateyr	obdatemm	obxp23x	obtc23x	perwt23f
2462070101	2462070101003301	2023	3	132	497	5,242
2462070101	2462070101003401	2023	1	319	462	5,242
2461266102	2461266102004401	2023	9	280	538	6,686

- Provider characteristics
- Services/procedures (e.g. surgery, lab tests)
- Health conditions
- Detailed expenditure variables

Healthcare Expenditures

- **Collected at the event level**
- **Represent payments to providers of the healthcare**
- **Payments are reported by source**
 - ▶ e.g. out-of-pocket, private insurance
- **Total expenditure is the sum of payments across all sources of payment**

Sources of Payment

Out of Pocket

- ▶ SF – self or family

Public

- ▶ MR – Medicare
- ▶ MD – Medicaid
- ▶ VA – VA/CHAMPVA

Private Insurance

- ▶ PV – Private Insurance
- ▶ TR – TRICARE

Other

- ▶ OF – other federal government
- ▶ SL – state or local government
- ▶ WC – worker's comp
- ▶ OT – other insurance

Total Expenditures (XP) =

Sum of payments from all 10
sources

Event File Expenditure Variables

OB, DN, HH and OM

- **10 expenditure by source of payment variables**
- **A total expenditure variable**
 - ▶ **sum of 10 source of payment variables**
- **A total charge variable**
 - ▶ **provider's charge before adjustment or discount**

Event File Expenditure Variables (continued – 2)

OB Event File, 2023

evntidx	obsf23x	obmd23x	...	obpv23x	obxp23x	obtc23x
2462070101003301	0	132	...	0	132	497
2462070101003401	0	319	...	0	319	462
2461266102004401	25	0	...	255	280	538

Event File Expenditure Variables (continued – 3)

Hospital: IP, OP and ER

- **Facility Expenditure Variables**
 - ▶ 10 expenditure by source of payment variables
 - ▶ A total facility expenditure variable
 - ▶ A total facility charge variable
 - **Separately Billing Doctor (SBD) Expenditure Variables**
 - ▶ 10 SBD expenditure by source of payment variables
 - ▶ A total SBD expenditure variable
 - ▶ A total SBD charge variable
- Total expenditures for the event: facility + SBD expenditures
 - Total charges for the event: facility + SBD charges

Event File Expenditure Variables (continued – 4)

ER Event File, 2023

Facility payments (f)

evntidx	erfsf23x	erfmd23x	erfpv23x	erfxp23x	erftc23x
2460114103026401	50	0	1,481	1,531	2,730
2460115101001801	498	0	2,822	3,321	4,427

SBD payments (d)

Total SBD pmt

SBD charge

erdsf23x	erdmnd23x	erdpv23x	erdxp23x	erdtc23x
0	0	54	54	83
0	0	30	152	992

Total payment (facility + SBD)

Total charge (facility + SBD)

erxp23x	ertc23x
1,584	2,813
3,472	5,419

Event File Expenditure Variables (continued – 5)

RX ('PMED')

- Multiple RX scripts can be linked to single visit
- Not all RX are linked to a medical visit
- 10 expenditure by source of payment variables
- A total expenditure variable
 - ▶ Sum of 10 source of payment variables
- A total charge variable

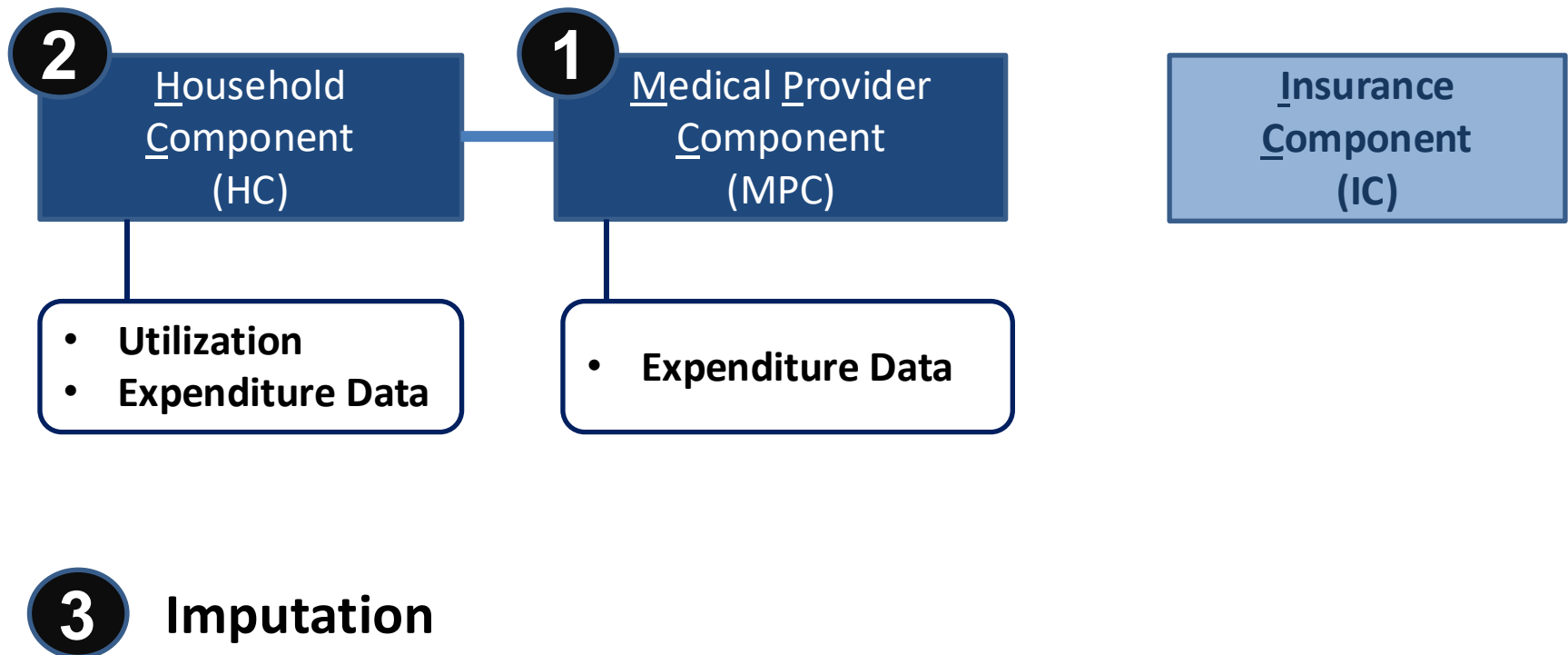
Event File Expenditure Variables (continued – 6)

Telehealth visits:

- **A telehealth module was fielded starting with P23 R7, P24 R5, P25 R3**
- **These were then reclassified as either OB or OP based on whether the respondent identified the provider or facility as owned and operated by a hospital.**

Sources of Expenditure Data

Medical Expenditure Panel Survey (MEPS)



Sources of Expenditure Data by Event Type

Event Type	HC	MPC
Office based: physician	✓	✓
Office based: nonphysician	✓	
Inpatient	✓	✓
Outpatient	✓	✓
ER	✓	✓
Dental	✓	
RX		✓
Home health: agency		✓
Home health: paid independent	✓	
Other medical	✓	

Sources of Expenditure Data

dupersid	evntidx	impflag	obxp23x	obtc23x
2462070101	2462070101003301	2	132	497
2462070101	2462070101003401	3	319	462
2461266102	2461266102004401	2	280	538

impflag*

- 0 Not eligible for imputation**
- 1 Complete HC data**
- 2 Complete MPC data**
- 3 Fully imputed**
- 4 Partially imputed**
- 5 Capitation imputation**

* Codes are different for RX file

Medical Provider Component

The MPC is NOT...

...designed to yield national estimates

...available to the public

The MPC is...

...a supplement to household-reported expenditure data

...used for internal methodological studies

Special Cases

Flat fees

Zero-dollar events

Capitation

“-1” and other missing codes

Special Cases

Flat fees

- Fixed dollar amount for a group of healthcare services
 - ▶ e.g., orthodontic, prenatal care
- Flat Fee ID: FFEEIDX
- Flat fee structure (FFOBTYPE)
 - ▶ **Stem** - initial medical visit - **expenditures**
 - ▶ **Leaf** - subsequent medical visits - **zero expenditures**

Special Cases

Flat fees

Zero-dollar events

- Flat fee – leaf event
- Follow-up visit with no extra charge
- Free care
- Bad debt

Special Cases

Flat fees

Zero-dollar events

Capitation

- Imputed to fee-for-service equivalence
- **IMPFLAG = 5**

Special Cases

Flat fees

Zero-dollar events

Capitation

“-1” and other missing codes

- HH – informal care (MPCELIG = 3)

Missing data codes

- 1 Inapplicable
- 7 Refused
- 8 Don't know
- 15 Value cannot be derived

Annual Person-Level File

- **Event-level files**
 - ▶ Separated by type of service
 - ▶ Unique record for each reported event
 - Some persons have no events
 - Some persons have multiple events

- **Person-level file (full year consolidated)**
 - ▶ Variables derived from event level
 - ▶ One record for each person in MEPS
 - ▶ No detail on expenditures or characteristics of individual events
 - ▶ Summary of all events and expenditures
 - See [Appendix 3](#) of documentation for naming conventions

Annual Person-Level File



OB Event File, 2023

dupersid	evntidx	obdateyr	obdatemm	obxp23x	obtc23x	perwt23f
2462070101	2462070101003301	2023	3	132	497	5,242
2462070101	2462070101003401	2023	1	319	462	5,242
2461266102	2461266102004401	2023	9	280	538	6,686

Full Year Consolidated File, 2023

dupersid	obtotv23	obvexp23	obvtch23	perwt23f
2462070101	2	451	959	5,242
2461266102	1	280	538	6,686

MEPS Files

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⌵ Data Centers

Communication

⌵ What's New

⌵ Mailing List

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Categories

☒ Household Full Year Consolidated Data Files

Person level file

☒ Household Event Files

☒ Prescribed Medicines Files

☒ Dental Visits Files

☒ Other Medical Expenses Files

☒ Hospital Inpatient Stays Files

☒ Emergency Room Visits Files

☒ Outpatient Visits Files

☒ Office-Based Medical Provider Visits Files

☒ Home Health Files

☒ Appendix to MEPS Event Files

Event files

Select All

Select None

☒ MEPS-NHIS Link Files

Thank You!



Jerrod.Anderson@ahrq.hhs.gov